

India is under commitment to work with USA for the Conclusion of FMCT under Civil Nuclear Agreement.

• India's Evolving Position on Nuclear weapons —

i) India has been at the Fore-Front of Nuclear disarmament. Since beginning, India has been supporting a time-bound verifiable Universal Nuclear Disarmament.

India's 1st P.M. Pt. Nehru held that Nuclear weapons are Shaitanic.

Gandhi called Nuclear weapons as most diabolical use of Science.

How Others looked at India ? —

Expert on South Asia Stephen P. Cohen in his book "Emerging ^{Power} India" — mentions that Emerging Power India was never faithful w.r.t its position on disarmament. India was buying time. India always had aspiration to be recognised as Great Power.

Pt. Nehru himself laid the objective, that India should get the rightful place in "Comity of Nations".

He mentions that Pt. Nehru's Atomic Energy Programme was never entirely peaceful, it always has Strategic Orientation.

Why he says so? —

— From the very beginning, Programme was under lots of Secrecy. The details were not accessible to Media.

- C. Rajamohan in his book Crossing the Rubicon mentions that the question was never, whether India will acquire Nuclear Weapon rather the question was When.

When it will be the right time to declare Nuclear Weapon status.

- Manpreet Sethi — has given the evolution of India's Nuclear Weapon status. A/c to her, picture became clear after India lost war to China in 1962 and when China acquired the capability in 1964. Thus, more than Pakistan China has been the factor shaping India's choices.

Since India got Nuclear Umbrella of USSR, India could continue to stick on Moral High Grounds.

India use the platform of NAM & UNGA, has been an active Participant in Disarmament talks at Conference on Disarmament at Geneva.

Since 1982, India has been regularly introducing Annual Resolutions in UNGA for prohibition of Nuclear weapons.

India made the last Determined push in 1988 in the form of Rajiv Gandhi Action Plan on Nuclear Disarmament.

Time-bound Elimination.! —

- ↳ He proposed Gradual Elimination in 3 Stages & as per plan by 2010 world would have become Nuclear weapon free.

(2)

However, West didn't accept India's Plan.

Why? -

- i) Nuclear weapons are the Ultimate instruments of US Hegemony.
 - ii) India got strong support from USSR.
- Hence West interpreted it as Russia's Plan, it died Prematurity.

* Post Cold War Environment :-

India felt orphaned, India had to look for its Security as Security Environment Changed.

1st Phase :- Till 1998 :-

- India's Relations with US did not change in a big way. There was apprehension against US. US also didn't want the Emergence of another Nuclear State. Hence, US kept on Pressurising India to sign —

a) NPT

b) CTBT —
↳

The way Clinton administration was pressurising India and was also very actively making efforts for Conclusion of CTBT. Hence, India decided to cross the Rubicon. Uptil now, approach of India was to maintain Threshold Status means having Capacity but not testing. Congress policy was of maintaining the threshold. It seems that it was more intelligent choice.

Why India decided to go Nuclear in 1998? -

- i) US pressure to sign CTBT.
- ii) China Challenge.
- iii) Elections. — The strongest reason was domestic politics.

Indian Elites took "Calculated Risk". They knew that there will be sanctions against India but India realised its Strategic Position as a Swing State in the Emerging Geo-Politics. India knew that sanctions will not continue for long & west will prefer Nuclear India as a better balance to China rather than Non-Nuclear.

Different Countries have different motivation for acquiring Nuclear weapons. A/c to transport Sethi, India's main motivation was prestige → Getting Permanent Seat in UNSC.

India adopted no 1st use approach. The architect of India's draft Nuclear Doctrine was K. Subramaniam. It was the 1st work of the newly constituted national Security Council. Draft Nuclear Doctrine was given in 1999. Later on, Cabinet Committee on Security released a modified Doctrine in 2003. It is to be noted that all the features of Doctrine are not in Public.

What are the Core Principles of India's Nuclear Doctrine? -

Do you think there is a need to revise the Fundamental Principles? What is the purpose of Nuclear Doctrine? -

It is customary to explain to the World the reason behind acquiring Nuclear Weapons b/c of the Sensitive Nature. The purpose of the doctrines is Confidence building measure.

Nuclear Doctrine differs from Nuclear posture. Doctrine represent core principles. Posture represent actions based on principles.

Normally, doctrines are stable and postures are adjusted from time to time.

* Fundamental Principles :-

- i) NFU
- ii) MCD (Minimum Credible Deterrence)
- iii) massive Retaliation — in case Indian Citizens & armed forces are attacked by Nuclear weapons or ~~use~~ even Chemical or biological weapon.
- iv) Command & Controls of the Nuclear weapons to be in the hand of Civilians.
- v) India continues to believe in Nuclear Disarmament.

Despite the fact that India acquired Nuclear weapon, we continue to believe that India's Security is served better in a Nuclear weapon free world & India will continuously strive to achieve Nuclear weapon free world.

* Need for Revision :-

Its around 20 yrs and there is no harm in making Strategic assessment of security situation and modify Nuclear Posture.

In 2014, Manifesto of BJP, it was proposed that if they will come to power they will revise the Nuclear Doctrine.

Indian leaders & Civil servants Time and again make Informal statements about possibility of change.

Experts like — **Col. B.S. Nagal** who was a member of Strategic Forces Command mentioned that No 1st use policy is unethical, it is putting our population and forces under huge threat. In fact, there can be only 1st Use policy b/c survivability of the attack will always be questionable

6

A/c to the Experts like — **Vipin Norang**, there is no point discussing No 1st Use to 1st Use. There are enough indications that India has already moved towards 1st Use. For ex — Missile Defence, Surgical Strikers,

India's policy was never entirely No 1st Use.

- i) It is believed that it was only no 1st use w.r.t Non-Nuclear weapon state.
- ii) India has right to use Nuclear weapons in case of Attack by Chemical & Biological weapons.
- iii) No 1st use is a misleading term b/c in practice it will be difficult to establish whether the reaction is 1st use or no 1st use. If a Country takes pre-emptive strike whether it will be treated as 1st use or 2nd Use.

Should India formally declare 1st Use ? —

A/c to **Shiv Shankar Menon**, 1st Use policy will create new arms race. It will give an excuse to China to change to 1st Use.

1st Use comes with inherent dangers. 1st Use will require launchers and explosives to be kept in meeted form.

There is a possibility of accidental use.

A/c to **Manpreet Sethi**, Nuclear weapons are weapons of Deterrence & should not be mis-taken for weapons of war.

India maintains right to 2nd Strike that too by massive Retaliation. It is suggested that Counter force Response should also be added.

India's policy is of minimum Credible Deterrence (MCD). We focus on minimum weapons & we are not in any blind arm race. However, a/c to the critics, Minimum is never Credible. Hence, it should be Credible Minimum Deterrence.

However, a/c to Experts, MCD is better b/c credibility does not depend on number. Credibility is a Psychological Concept. For Credibility, other things are also important:-

- i) Willingness to use Nuclear weapons.
- ii) How efficient is Command & Control.
- iii) How efficient is our disaster management.

In fact, to increase the credibility India should insist on No 1st Use.

Manpreet Sethi suggest, India should actually remove the Refrain of Chemical & biological weapon in Nuclear Doctrine.

Why? -

- B/c there are separate Conventions for these weapons.

We should focus more on the robustness of Command and Control.

* India on Disarmament ! —

India has always been a crusader for Nuclear Disarmament. In 2006, India presented a working paper titled — "Nuclear Disarmament". (8)

India gave following suggestions! —

- a) Step by Step Disarmament w/c presented by Rajiv Gandhi.
 - b) Multi-lateral & Verifiable system.
 - c) India proposed "Global No 1st Use."
- P.M. Modi in his speech to UNGA, Reiterated India's willingness to work with any country with open mindedness to address the threat.

In UNGA he reiterated

शान्ति भद्राः कृत्वो
सन्तु विश्वतः

↓
let noble thoughts come to us
from all directions.